# Chapter 14: Propose. Get Feared.

Rhys was taken to the complex and put in bed. The rest of team Terrian and team Cruia came with him. Catria did more healing of him, but with as near death as he was and as weak as Catria was, he wouldn't be up soon."

"I'm done," Rhys announced. "I want to retire."

"You'll be recovered and up to fighting again soon," Hrod assured him.

"No," Rhys corrected. "I was honestly debating retiring anyway. I have been captain a long time, and I'm tired of fighting. I want you to be the next captain, Hrod."

"You can't retire," Hrod countered. "We don't have a war mage to replace you. You can't retire until the next soul quest."

"I can replace him," Erik offered. "I don't want to be captain, as I'm new, but I can transfer to Team Terrian." He looked over at Dillion. "You'd approve that, wouldn't

you?”

“We will miss you in the team,” Dillion replied. “But I encourage you to.” He winked at him. “You know that.”

Dillion then sat beside Rhys. “You may not be up to considering this yet, but you will lose your province in Terrian when you retire. Would you like to retire to Team Cruia. We seldom fight, but we could use you until the next soul quest if we need an additional man. You likely won’t have to fight at all, and I bet you’d enjoy Cruia. It’s a great place for a war mage to retire to. You’re a hard worker.”

Rhys looked half asleep but mumbled, “It sounds nice. I’ll consider it when I can think straight.”

Hrod chimed in, “I don’t want to be team captain. You know the new rule that the captain gets beaten if an attack is made and the team loses.”

“That’s one more reason I want to retire,” Rhys noted weakly. “Can someone get me food?”

Hrod offered to, so he left. Sean stayed to watch over Rhys, and Catria and the rest of teams Terrian and Cruia went to the dining hall to get dinner.

Erick and Catria served themselves and sat at a table together, expecting the rest of their teams to sit with them, but none of them did.

Erik chuckled. “I think my team is trying to give me a push.”

“Push to what?” Catria asked innocently.

Erik took a bite of meat and finished it before explaining, “Catria, I don’t ever want to see you wounded in a battle again.”

“But I’m a war mage,” Catria pointed out. “That happens. I knew the risk when I became a war mage, and I knew the risk when I took the field.”

Erik nodded back. “You are amazing. Your team would have lost without you. Likely, Rhys and others would have died. I just don’t want to see you hurt again.”

She cocked her head curiously. “Do you want me to stop being a war mage?”

“No,” Erik answered. “You can do great good as one. I just want to always be there to fight with you.”

She smiled at him. “You can be if you join Team Terrian. I’ll enjoy having you on the team.”

His eyes met hers, and he took her hand before confessing, “Catria, I don’t want to just join Team Terrian. I want to marry you.”

Catria stared for a moment in shock and then managed to get out the words, “Are you…”

“Yes,” Erik admitted. “But let me do this right.”

He called to the other war mages in the room, which was mostly Terrian and Cruia, but some mages from Alfir and Ramere were there too, “Everyone, may I have your attention.”

He then took Catria’s hand, raised her from her chair, knelt before her, and took a deep breath to counter his

nerves. “Catria,” he began. “I know we have not known each other long, but I’ve known since the soul quest that you are the lady of my dreams. As I’ve come to know you, I am even more sure. I love you, Catria. Will you marry me?”

“Yes,” Catria answered with a bounce and excited literal glow. She threw her arms around him and hugged him. As the two embraced, a brighter glow shone, as his added to hers.

Everyone was excited for them, except for Calix, a part grogosh war mage from Alfir. He sat at a table in the corner of the room, nearly invisible as he drank a mug of cream, and whispered to a part-sprite war mage beside him, “This is bad. These two are going to be too strong together.”

“Do we need to tell Peri?” Lysander, the part sprite asked.

“No,” Calix answered. “We need to tell Slayde and our councilman. York will want to know. These two will be a problem that must be taken care of.”

Lysander smiled. “I’ll do it, if the pay is good enough.”

Calix shook his head. “It won’t be that easy. These to together may be tougher than all our team together.”

Lysander looked at him, fear rising from his expression. “You’re right. They must be stopped.”